



» INDIAN FOOTBALL

MAIDEN MOMENT

East Bengal won the Indian Women's League title for the first time, breaking **multiple records** along the way.

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“I know what it takes to be a champion.” Anthony Andrews (**right**) wasn't lying. He had just led East Bengal to its maiden Indian Women's League (IWL) title in the 2024-25 season.

This was also the 29-year-old coach's third championship — he had previously won two consecutive titles with Gokulam Kerala between 2021 and 2023.

In addition to roping in serial winner Andrews, the Kolkata-based side also secured the services of several India internationals, including Sweetie Devi, Anju Tamang, Ashalata Devi, Sandhiya Ranganathan and others. The team also boasted a formidable overseas contingent, spearheaded by Ghanaian forward

Elshaddai Acheampong, who ended the campaign with 10 goals — East Bengal's top scorer and the second-highest scorer of the season.

While the Red and Gold Brigade romped to the title — breaking multiple records and losing just once en route to a spot in the preliminary stage of the AFC Women's Champions League — defending champion Odisha FC endured a fall from grace.

The team finished seventh and was relegated to IWL 2 — the second tier of Indian



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